calendar, the director of the NMML went on three months' leave. She appointed a recently recruited consultant to act as director in her place. The person in question had previously been an official of the India Tourism Development Corporation, in charge of duty-free shops at airports.

Now, courtesy her contacts and her cronies, this person sat in the chair once occupied by B.R. Nanda and Ravinder Kumar.

And worse was to follow. In May 2010, I was sent a copy of an independent audit of the NMML, which had been recently submitted to the ministry of culture. The forty-three pages of this report were peppered with the words 'irregular' and

'profligate'. The audit report observed that since the new

director took over in 2006, the NMML had recruited as many as sixty-four consultants, with several people being paid for the same job (while thirty-nine sanctioned staff posts remain unfilled). Meanwhile, there had 'been [an]

abject failure on the part of the NMML so far as research work is concerned'. The financial implications of these irregular appointments were 'astronomical'; moreover, these favoured consultants often had 'no experience whatsoever'. As the audit report dryly

observed, this 'shows the utter contempt with which NMML handles various economy instructions issued by the Ministry of Finance'. The report concluded that the 'NMML appears to be working with a mind set to provide benefit to individuals rather than to the Institution'.

IX

I suppose I should have been more realistic about, or more resigned to, the deterioration of the Nehru Memorial Museum and Library. I had myself written (in a book published in 1999) about how institutions in India worked well only for short periods of time. I had just been to the Christa Seva Sangh in Puné, a once-thriving centre of thought and action founded by the radical priest J.C. Winslow, which had sought to make Indian Christians more sensitive to the ideas and programme of Mahatma Gandhi.